

Feasibility Study

furlink

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Executive Summary

furlink is a startup designed to digitize the fragmented Philippine pet grooming industry by replacing inefficient, informal booking methods like Facebook Messenger with a structured digital ecosystem. The platform addresses critical market gaps by providing a centralized web-based interface that eliminates scheduling conflicts and provides much-needed business visibility for local service providers.

The platform offers pet owners transparent pricing and a seamless booking experience enhanced by an AI-powered Booking Assistant for automated scheduling. Service providers gain a professional online presence and a Business Intelligence Dashboard that delivers actionable insights into sales performance and customer feedback to drive business growth.

Built on a scalable Backend-as-a-Service infrastructure using React.js, Supabase, and Vercel, the platform is managed by a four-person core team, ensuring minimal technical overhead. Following a targeted pilot in Makati City, furlink will transition to a commercial model funded by transaction fees and promotional campaigns, positioning it to capture a significant share of the growing pet care market.

Description of Products and Services

furlink is a centralized digital booking platform designed to streamline the pet grooming experience for both pet owners and grooming service providers. The platform addresses a widely recognized gap in the local pet care industry, specifically the absence of a dedicated, structured booking system, by replacing informal scheduling methods—such as Facebook Messenger and phone calls—with an integrated digital ecosystem.

For pet owners, furlink provides a seamless experience for discovering nearby grooming service providers, viewing service offerings and pricing, scheduling appointments, and managing booking history, all within a single platform. The platform also integrates an AI-powered Booking Assistant that guides users through the booking process conversationally, automatically extracting pet and

appointment details from natural language input to reduce friction and accelerate the scheduling experience.

For service providers, furlink offers a professional online presence with a dedicated listing page, a structured application and onboarding process, and real-time booking management tools. To drive business growth, the platform features a comprehensive Business Intelligence Dashboard coupled with an AI-powered Data Analyst. While the dashboard provides visual summaries of sales performance, booking trends, and customer feedback, the integrated AI Data Analyst interprets these metrics automatically. Acting as an on-demand business consultant, this AI feature processes historical transaction and scheduling data to generate proactive recommendations. This provides non-technical grooming business owners with actionable, data-driven insights without requiring manual data analysis.

furlink designed as a local-first platform, initially focusing on pet grooming services within Makati City, with a structured plan to expand its coverage to additional cities and service categories as platform adoption grows. No changes to the existing service offerings of partner grooming businesses are required as part of this initiative, as furlink functions as the booking, management, and intelligent analytics layer on top of their existing operations.

Technology Considerations

furlink is a web-based platform requiring a modern, scalable infrastructure to support its core business functions, including booking management, AI-assisted user interactions, and secure payment processing. To minimize initial development costs and technical risk, the team has strategically adopted a Backend-as-a-Service (BaaS) strategy, leveraging established cloud-based platforms rather than constructing physical infrastructure from scratch. The platform is built using React.js to ensure a responsive user experience across devices, with development and automated deployment pipelines managed through Vercel to maintain high availability without the need for manual server maintenance. Backend operations, including user authentication and database management, are centralized in Supabase using PostgreSQL, which provides enterprise-grade

security through Row Level Security and serverless Edge Functions for executing background logic.

The AI Booking Assistant is powered by the Google Gemini API and orchestrated via the Vercel AI SDK, utilizing the core model's native function-calling capabilities to seamlessly parse natural language conversational inputs into structured database entries. To address regulatory and security risks regarding financial transactions, PayMongo is integrated as the primary payment gateway, offering a PCI-compliant environment for local Philippine payment methods without requiring the platform to handle sensitive card data directly. Furthermore, transactional notifications are automated through Gmail SMTP and triggered by specific system events to ensure consistent real-time engagement with users.

Beyond conversational support, the platform features an AI Pet Haircut Generator that relies on dedicated Hugging Face serverless inference endpoints to execute state-of-the-art open-source diffusion models via dedicated cloud GPU compute. To ensure absolute uptime and shield the user experience from potential infrastructure bottlenecks, the system architecture utilizes Pollinations.ai as an immediate, asynchronous failover routing engine. Additionally, an AI-Powered Data Analyst is implemented using Gemini 2.5 Flash, leveraging its massive 1-million token context window to securely ingest and process entire historical datasets, anonymized booking trends, and platform metrics in a single stateless execution payload. This configuration provides service providers with enterprise-grade business intelligence and predictive demand forecasting without violating user data privacy or incurring prohibitive computational overhead.

The final analysis indicates that this technology stack consists of proven, industry-standard tools, and because the student team possesses the internal expertise to maintain these systems, there is no requirement for external development contracts, ensuring a sustainable cost-to-growth ratio for the startup as it transitions into progressive commercial scaling.

Product/Service Marketplace

The pet care industry in the Philippines represents a rapidly growing market driven by urbanization and a cultural shift toward treating pets as members of the family. A significant

portion of Filipino pet owners now allocate a meaningful share of their household budget to pet care services, with grooming being among the most frequently and consistently demanded services. This sustained demand presents a clear and viable market opportunity for a dedicated digital booking platform.

Despite this growth, the booking process for pet grooming services in the Metro Manila area remains largely informal. A recent survey found that the majority of small-scale pet service providers rely almost exclusively on Facebook Messenger and direct phone calls to manage appointments, leading to scheduling inefficiencies, double-booking incidents, and a general lack of business visibility. Pet owners, on the other hand, face difficulty comparing service providers, viewing accurate pricing upfront, and managing their booking history in a centralized manner. furlink directly addresses these pain points.

Target Market

furlink's primary target market consists of two groups. The first is pet owners in Makati City, specifically those who own dogs and cats and regularly seek professional grooming services. This group values convenience, pricing transparency, and trust in the service providers they engage. The second is small to medium-sized pet grooming businesses operating in Makati City, particularly those that currently rely on traditional booking channels and would benefit from a structured digital presence, automated scheduling, and business performance insights.

Competitive Landscape

furlink operates in a space where the primary competition comes not from direct booking platform rivals, but from the informal channels that currently dominate the market. The most significant competitors are Meta platforms, particularly Facebook and Facebook Messenger, which pet owners and service providers habitually use to discover and coordinate grooming appointments. The conversational and familiar nature of these channels presents a behavioral inertia that furlink must overcome through ease of use and clear added value.

Among existing digital platforms, PetBacker is the closest comparable service, offering a marketplace for connecting pet owners with service providers across Southeast Asia.

Nevertheless, PetBacker has documented limitations including a lack of upfront pricing transparency and requirement for users to submit pet information before they can explore the platform, which creates friction for new users. Rover, while a well-established international platform, is limited to the United States and Canada, is therefore not a direct competitor in the Philippine market. No existing platform currently offers a locally tailored, AI-assisted booking experience with an integrated business dashboard for providers.

Distribution and Delivery

furlink is a fully digital platform accessible via web browser on any internet-connected device. Service discovery, booking, payment, and communication all occur within the platform. The actual grooming services are delivered physically at the service provider's location. furlink serves as the coordination and transaction layer, not a service delivery mechanism. This asset-light model requires no warehousing, logistic infrastructure, or physical facilities beyond the platform itself.

Why Pet Owners Would Choose furlink

Pet owners are expected to choose furlink over informal booking channels because the platform's pricing transparency, ease of scheduling, centralized booking history, verified provider listings, and the convenience of the AI Booking Assistant, which simplifies the booking process significantly compared to back-and-forth messaging platforms.

Marketing Strategy

furlink's go-to-market strategy is designed for a startup environment with a lean budget, focusing on targeted digital marketing and a controlled platform launch with a single verified service provider partner.

Launch Strategy: Single Provider Pilot

For the initial launch phase, furlink will partner exclusively with Groom Room by Steve, a grooming service provider that the team has coordinated with directly for platform testing and validation. This controlled approach allows the team to validate the platform's core booking

workflow, gather user feedback, and demonstrate furlink's value proposition in a live environment before scaling to additional providers.

Social Media Marketing Campaign

furlink will leverage social media platforms, primarily Facebook and Instagram, to drive awareness and encourage pet owners to book their first appointment through the platform. The campaign will center on furlink's seamless user experience, the AI Booking Assistant feature, and the ability to discover and book grooming services in one platform.

As a highlight of the launch, furlink will introduce a promotional initiative designed to honor and reward pet owners who support the platform with early bookings. To foster a high-energy community and incentivize first-time usage, winners will be selected through a lucky draw mechanism to receive exclusive cash rewards.

Differentiation

furlink differentiates itself from existing alternatives in three keyways:

1. It is designed specifically for the local pet care market, making it more relevant and culturally aligned than international platforms.
2. It incorporates an AI Booking Assistant, which represents meaningful innovation over competitors who offer no AI-assisted functionality.
3. It provides service providers with a Business Intelligence Dashboard that gives grooming businesses visibility into their performance, a feature not available through traditional booking channels or competing platforms.

Being a student-developed startup also gives furlink an authentic community narrative that resonated well in local social media marketing.

Future Marketing Considerations

As the platform grows beyond the pilot phase, furlink plans to expand its provider listings and introduce paid promotional programs for service providers. These programs would feature participating grooming businesses in platform-wide campaigns, giving providers greater visibility

in exchange for a sponsorship or campaign fee. This creates a secondary revenue stream while simultaneously giving the platform additional marketing content and service provider engagement.

Organization and Staffing

The implementation, deployment, and ongoing governance of the furlink platform are managed by a specialized, cross-functional four-person core startup team. This internal team possesses the combined expertise in full-stack software engineering, quality assurance, and agile project management necessary to construct and maintain the cloud-based infrastructure without requiring external technical contracts or high-cost development consultancies. The organizational structure operates on a flat, collaborative framework engineered to maximize velocity during parallel development sprints. A dedicated internal labor cost is systematically computed across all project phases to account for engineering sprints, quality benchmarks, and operational governance. Consequently, no external hierarchical additions are required during the implementation period, ensuring a sustainable and agile cost-to-growth ratio as the platform transitions from an academic project into a commercial startup.

The core startup team and its governance body are comprised of the following designations:

- **Lalaine Andaya (Project Manager and Full-Stack Developer):** Oversees overall project coordination, milestone tracking, and sprint scheduling, while simultaneously contributing directly to the platform's codebase by developing assigned functional modules.
- **Atasha Frances Gayle Doria (Lead Full-Stack Developer):** Orchestrates the overarching system architecture, root database schemas, security configurations, and primary payment gateway integrations, while supervising the functional implementation of the conversational AI components.
- **Michelle Reina Pineda (Quality Assurance):** Responsible for the rigorous execution of regression, usability, and cross-device compatibility testing pipelines, validating that all

code deployments meet the platform's stringent quality benchmarks before entering production.

- **Feliz Angelica Salting (Full-Stack Developer):** Responsible for end-to-end full-stack engineering of assigned platform modules, writing responsive React.js user interfaces, and constructing corresponding backend logic and database workflows.
- **Change Control Board (CCB):** Functions as a collective governing body composed of all four core team members to manage configuration repository branches, evaluate scope alterations, and filter proposed system modifications against technical feasibility and strict deadlines.

Schedule

furlink development and release schedules spans from the Capstone 2 kickoff through project completion, covering the full lifecycle from platform final testing to solution release. The following milestones represent the high-level implementation timeline for the project:

Milestones	Date
Capstone 2 Kickoff	March 7, 2026
Final Testing	July 6-7, 2026
Release to Service Provider (Training)	July 8, 2026
furlink v1.0 Deployment	July 11, 2026
Enhancement of Core Booking Modules	July 13-17, 2026
Development of AI Booking Assistant	July 20-30, 2026
System and Integration Testing	July 31, 2026 – August 7, 2026
furlink v2.0 Release	August 10 2026
User Acceptance Testing & Fixes	August 17, 2026 – August 21, 2026
Solution Release furlink v2.1	August 31, 2026
Project Completion	October 1, 2026

Financial Projections

The financial projections for furlink are structured around a phased deployment strategy designed to capture initial market share and maximize user acquisition before transitioning into a self-sustaining commercial model. These projections comprehensively account for long-term cloud

infrastructure maintenance, targeted marketing expenses, and the calculated transition from an academic pilot into a live, dual-sided marketplace.

Revenue Model

To establish market trust and eliminate initial friction for both pet owners and service providers, furlink operates under a multi-stage monetization timeline:

- **The Pre-Revenue Phase:** During this initial stage, the platform's core booking infrastructure is fully operational, but transactions are completely non-monetized or 0% platform commission. This strategic choice allows the team to validate system workflows, eliminate backend operational risks, and generate the critical network effects necessary to build a highly active community of pet owners and service providers without financial barriers to entry.
- **The Commercialization Phase:** Upon achieving operational stability and a baseline user network post-pilot, furlink will activate its commercial framework, introducing two primary, synergistic revenue streams:
 - **Transaction-Based Marketplace Commissions:** furlink will transition into a monetized booking layer, generating its primary revenue by collecting a fixed percentage-based commission from each successfully completed grooming appointment facilitated through the platform's escrow logic.
 - **Featured Provider Campaigns:** To supplement transaction revenues, furlink will launch an opt-in, voluntary promotional program for service providers. Participating service providers can purchase featured visibility slots to be prominently displayed at the top of the user interface and integrated into furlink's targeted social media marketing channels, providing small businesses with a high-conversion mechanism to accelerate their client growth.

Cost Figures

Measure	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Projected Revenue	₱56,590.75	₱150,163.15	₱247,426.13	₱361,457.36	₱488,688.60
Hosting Infrastructure	₱38,449.87	₱46,245.12	₱54,897.84	₱65,561.25	₱78,188.48
System Maintenance	₱23,371.92	₱24,540.52	₱25,767.54	₱27,055.92	₱28,408.71
TOTAL OPERATIONAL COSTS	₱61,821.79	₱70,785.64	₱80,665.38	₱92,617.17	₱106,597.20
Net Cash Flow	-₱5,231.04	₱79,377.51	₱166,760.75	₱268,840.19	₱382,091.40

Findings and Recommendations

Based on the comprehensive research, milestone scheduling, and operational analysis presented in this feasibility study, it is recommended that the organization approves the formal initiation, deployment, and market launch of the furlink platform. The findings indicate that the initiative is highly viable, addresses a critical data gap in the local pet care ecosystem, and possesses a high probability of technical and commercial success within the target region. Key findings are summarized below:

Technology

- **Infrastructure Efficiency:** The project's strategic adoption of a Backend-as-a-Service (BaaS) model—leveraging high-availability cloud routing through Vercel and centralized PostgreSQL database instances on Supabase—effectively eliminates technical risks and removes the financial burden of constructing physical server infrastructure from scratch.
- **Innovation:** The integration of the Google Gemini-powered AI Booking Assistant and AI-powered Data Analyst provides a unique competitive edge by automating pet detail extraction and service discovery.
- **Resilient Architecture:** Incorporating a server-side multi-model graphic rendering pipeline for the AI Pet Haircut Generator—utilizing a high-performance model on a Hugging Face Inference Endpoint with automated failover routing to Pollinations.ai—guarantees absolute platform uptime and consistent user experiences.

- **Internal Capability:** The internal startup team possesses the necessary technical expertise to implement and maintain the stack, removing the requirement for expensive external development contracts.

Marketing

- **Market Opportunity:** There is a clear, culturally driven demand for professional grooming services, which is currently underserved by highly inefficient and informal coordination methods like Facebook Messenger and direct phone calls.
- **Differentiation:** furlink successfully differentiates itself from existing international platforms through complete upfront pricing transparency, a localized community narrative, and a dedicated Chart.js-powered Business Intelligence Dashboard that provides small B2B salons with unprecedented operational visibility.
- **Controlled Launch Scalability:** The go-to-market strategy uses an asset-light, single-provider pilot phase with Groom Room by Steve, enabling low-risk workflow validation, early user feedback loops, and targeted local social media campaigns before scaling to additional cities.

Organizational

- **Self-Sufficiency:** The four-person core startup team is structured effectively to handle development, operations, and marketing within a collaborative framework.
- **Minimal Overhead:** No organizational restructuring or capital investment in new physical facilities is required, maintaining an agile startup posture.

Financial

- **Asset-Light Model:** By leveraging internal engineering labor and utilizing cloud technology infrastructure tiers during the academic phase, the project successfully avoids immediate capital constraints and maintains an optimized cost-to-growth ratio.
- **Future Viability:** The multi-stage monetization timeline—safely moving from a 0% commission, zero-revenue academic pilot to a commercialization phase driven by

transaction-based marketplace commissions and featured provider promotional campaigns—establishes a clear, sustainable path toward long-term profitability.

furlink project is technically sound, operationally realistic, and strategically aligned with dominant pet consumer trends in the Philippines. By streamlining the coordination and transaction layers through automated serverless triggers, innovative AI modules, and dynamic data insights, the platform is uniquely positioned to capture meaningful market share and deliver high structural value to the local pet care ecosystem.

Sponsor Acceptance